

SS3 FOOD AND NUTRITION LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: BEVERAGES

1.1 EXPLAIN THE TERM BEVERAGES

A **beverage** is any type of drink, other than plain water, consumed by humans for quenching thirst, for its stimulating effect, for its nutritional value, or for refreshment. Beverages form a significant part of the human diet and play important roles in social and cultural contexts.

1.2 CLASSIFY BEVERAGES INTO ALCOHOLIC AND NON-ALCOHOLIC

Beverages are broadly classified into two major groups based on their alcohol (specifically, ethanol) content:

1. Alcoholic Beverages: These are drinks that contain a significant amount of ethanol (alcohol), a psychoactive drug that acts as a depressant. They are typically produced by the fermentation of grains, fruits, or other sources of sugar. They are generally consumed for their intoxicating effects and in social settings.

- **Examples:**

- **Fermented:** Beer (from barley), Wine (from grapes), Cider (from apples), Palm wine (from palm sap).
- **Distilled (Spirits):** Whisky (from grains), Rum (from sugarcane), Brandy (from distilled wine), Gin (from grains, flavoured with juniper berries), Vodka (from grains or potatoes), Ogogoro (local gin).

2. Non-Alcoholic Beverages: These are drinks that contain either no alcohol or legally negligible amounts of alcohol (e.g., less than 0.5% ABV). They are consumed for various reasons, including hydration, stimulation, nutrition, and pleasure.

- **Examples:**

- Water (mineral, purified, sparkling).
- Milk and milk-based drinks (chocolate milk, milkshakes).
- Tea (black, green, herbal).
- Coffee (espresso, cappuccino).
- Cocoa and hot chocolate.
- Fruit Juices (orange, pineapple, mango).
- Carbonated Drinks (soda, cola, lemonade).
- Malt drinks.
- Local drinks (Zobo, Kunu, Soya milk).

1.3 DISCUSS THE NUTRITIVE VALUE OF BEVERAGES

The nutritive value of beverages varies dramatically, from almost zero to highly nutritious.

- **Non-Alcoholic Beverages:**

- **High Nutritive Value:**

- **Milk:** Excellent source of protein (casein), calcium, phosphorus, riboflavin (B2), and vitamins A & D (if fortified).
- **Fruit Juices (100%):** Rich in Vitamin C (e.g., citrus), Vitamin A (e.g., mango, carrot), potassium, and natural sugars (carbohydrates) for energy.
- **Malt Drinks & Milk Shakes:** Provide carbohydrates for energy, some B-vitamins, and (if milk-based) protein and calcium.
- **Local Drinks (e.g., Kunu, Soya milk):** Kunu provides carbohydrates and B-vitamins. Soya milk is a good source of plant-based protein, iron, and B-vitamins.

- **Stimulating Value (Low Nutrition):**

- **Tea & Coffee:** Provide negligible nutrients, but contain **caffeine**, a stimulant that increases alertness. Tea also contains antioxidants (flavonoids).
- **Cocoa:** Provides some minerals (iron, magnesium) and antioxidants, as well as the stimulant **theobromine** (milder than caffeine).

- **Low/Empty Nutritive Value:**

- **Carbonated (Soda) Drinks:** Primarily water, sugar (or artificial sweeteners), and flavouring. They provide "empty calories" (energy with no other nutrients) and contribute to weight gain and tooth decay.
- **Water:** Essential for life, but provides no calories or macronutrients. It is a solvent, a transport medium, and a temperature regulator.
- **Alcoholic Beverages:**
 - They are generally considered to have **low nutritive value** but are **high in "empty" calories**.
 - **Alcohol (Ethanol):** Provides 7 kcal per gram (more than carbohydrates/protein but less than fat), but these calories lack associated nutrients.
 - **Beer:** Contains some carbohydrates and trace amounts of B-vitamins (from the yeast) and minerals.
 - **Wine:** Red wine, in particular, contains **antioxidants** (like resveratrol) from the grape skins, which are linked to some health benefits *in moderation*.
 - **Spirits:** Provide calories from alcohol only, with no other significant nutrients.
 - **Negative Effects:** Excessive alcohol consumption can lead to liver damage, addiction, and nutrient deficiencies by interfering with the absorption of B-vitamins (especially thiamine), zinc, and other nutrients.

1.4 HIGHLIGHT THE CHARACTERISTICS OF ALCOHOLIC AND NON-ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES

Feature	Alcoholic Beverages	Non-Alcoholic Beverages
Primary Ingredient	Ethanol (produced by fermentation)	Water
Primary Effect	Intoxicating, depressant, mood-altering.	Hydrating, stimulating, nourishing, or refreshing.
Nutritive Value	Generally low in nutrients, high in empty calories.	Varies from zero (water) to very high (milk, fruit juice).
Social Role	Often used in celebrations, social gatherings, religious rites. Regulated by	Consumed daily, by all ages, in all settings.

	age.	
Health Impact	Can be beneficial in <i>strict moderation</i> (e.g., red wine), but highly detrimental in excess.	Generally positive (hydration, nutrition) or negative if high in sugar (e.g., soda).
Examples	Wine, Beer, Spirits (Gin, Whisky), Palm Wine.	Tea, Coffee, Milk, Fruit Juice, Soda, Zobo.

EVALUATION

1. Define the term "beverage" in your own words.
2. List three examples of fermented alcoholic beverages and three examples of distilled alcoholic beverages.
3. Compare the nutritive value of a glass of milk, a glass of orange juice, and a glass of cola.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Research two traditional Nigerian non-alcoholic beverages (e.g., Zobo, Kunu). For each, list its main ingredients and its primary nutritional benefits.
2. Explain why alcoholic drinks are referred to as providing "empty calories."

WEEK 2: BEVERAGES (NON-ALCOHOLIC)

2.1 CLASSIFY NON-ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES

Non-alcoholic beverages can be classified based on their primary function or main ingredients.

The three main functional classes are:

1. **Stimulating Beverages:** Consumed primarily for their stimulating effect on the central nervous system, which helps to increase alertness and reduce fatigue.
2. **Refreshing Beverages:** Consumed primarily to quench thirst, cool the body, and provide refreshment.
3. **Nourishing (Nutritious) Beverages:** Consumed for their significant nutritional content (e.g., protein, vitamins, minerals, calories).

2.2 JUSTIFY EACH CLASS OF NON-ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES WITH EXAMPLES

1. Stimulating Beverages

These beverages contain alkaloids, which are naturally occurring chemical compounds that have a stimulating effect.

- **Justification:** Their main purpose is not nutrition or hydration, but to produce a specific physiological effect (alertness).
- **Examples:**
 - **Tea:**
 - **Source:** Leaves of the *Camellia sinensis* plant.
 - **Stimulant:** Caffeine and Theophylline.
 - **Types:** Black tea (fermented), Green tea (unfermented), Oolong tea (partially fermented).
 - **Coffee:**
 - **Source:** Roasted beans of the *Coffea* plant.
 - **Stimulant:** Caffeine (stronger than in tea).

- **Types:** Espresso, Cappuccino, Latte, Americano (all based on the brewing method).
- **Cocoa:**
 - **Source:** Beans from the *Theobroma cacao* tree.
 - **Stimulant: Theobromine** (a milder stimulant than caffeine).
 - **Use:** Used to make hot chocolate and as a flavouring.

2. Refreshing Beverages

These are designed to quench thirst. They are typically high in water content and often served chilled.

- **Justification:** Their primary value is hydration and sensory pleasure (taste, coolness).
- **Examples:**
 - **Water:** The most essential refreshing beverage. Can be tap, bottled, mineral, or sparkling (carbonated).
 - **Fruit Juices:**
 - **Source:** 100% juice pressed from fruits (e.g., orange, pineapple, apple, grape).
 - **Value:** Provide hydration, vitamins (esp. C), and natural sugars.
 - **Fruit Drinks (Squashes/Cordials):**
 - **Source:** Contain a smaller percentage of juice, mixed with water, sugar, and preservatives. Must be diluted.
 - **Value:** Primarily for flavour and hydration; less nutritious than pure juice.
 - **Carbonated Drinks (Sodas):**
 - **Source:** Water infused with carbon dioxide gas, plus sugar/sweeteners and flavours (e.g., Cola, Lemonade, Ginger Ale).
 - **Value:** Refreshing due to carbonation and cold, but often high in empty calories.
 - **Traditional Refreshers:**
 - **Zobo (Hibiscus Tea):** Made from dried *Hibiscus sabdariffa* flowers, often spiced with ginger and pineapple. Rich in Vitamin C.

- **Kunu:** A cereal-based drink from the northern part of Nigeria, made from millet or sorghum.

3. Nourishing Beverages

These beverages are consumed for their high caloric and/or nutrient content. They can often serve as a light meal or a supplement.

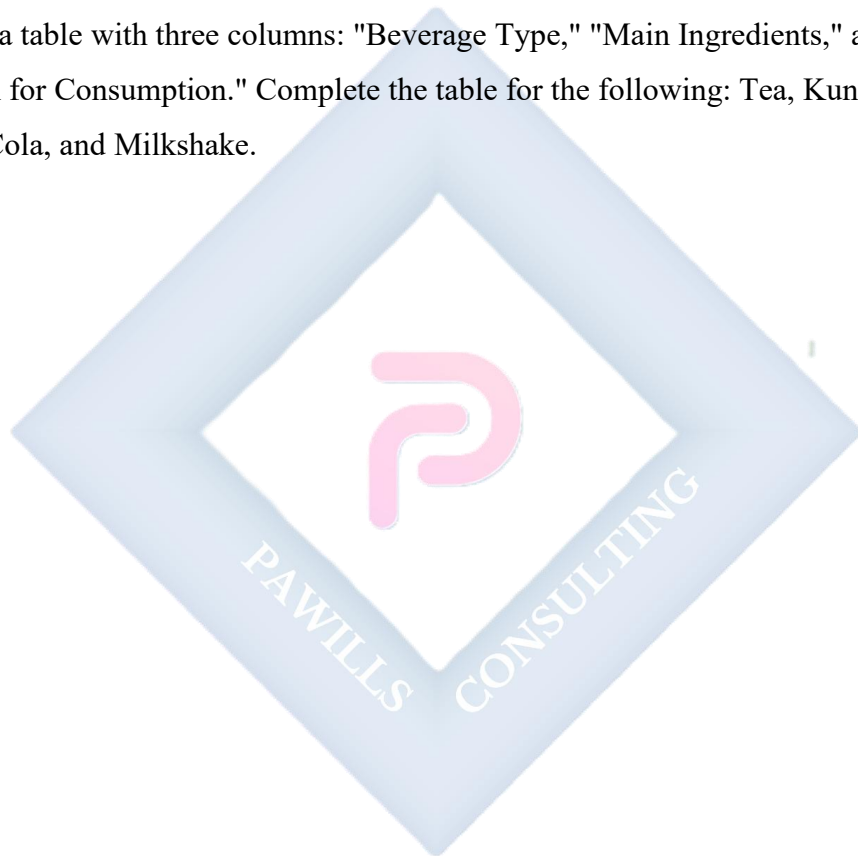
- **Justification:** Their primary value is nutritional. They provide energy, protein, vitamins, and minerals.
- **Examples:**
 - **Milk:**
 - **Source:** Mammary secretion from mammals (cow, goat).
 - **Value:** A "complete" food, rich in protein, fat, calcium, and vitamins. Can be consumed whole, skimmed, or evaporated.
 - **Soya Milk:**
 - **Source:** Plant-based milk from soaked, ground, and boiled soybeans.
 - **Value:** Excellent source of plant protein, iron, and B-vitamins. A key alternative for vegans or the lactose-intolerant.
 - **Malt Drinks:**
 - **Source:** Non-alcoholic drinks made from malted barley, hops, and water.
 - **Value:** Rich in carbohydrates (energy) and B-vitamins.
 - **Milk-Based Drinks:**
 - **Milkshakes:** Made by blending milk with ice cream and flavourings. High in calories, fat, and sugar.
 - **Egg Flip (Eggnog):** A rich drink made from milk, raw egg, sugar, and nutmeg. High in protein, fat, and calories. Often recommended for invalids.
 - **Yoghurt Drinks:**
 - **Source:** Fermented milk.
 - **Value:** Provide protein, calcium, and **probiotics** (beneficial bacteria) that aid digestion.

EVALUATION

1. Name the three main classes of non-alcoholic beverages.
2. What is the main chemical stimulant found in (a) coffee and (b) cocoa?
3. Give two examples of "refreshing" beverages and two examples of "nourishing" beverages.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Create a table with three columns: "Beverage Type," "Main Ingredients," and "Primary Reason for Consumption." Complete the table for the following: Tea, Kunu, Soya Milk, Coca-Cola, and Milkshake.



WEEK 3: SPECIAL DIET

3.1 EXPLAIN THE TERM SPECIAL DIET

A **Special Diet** (also known as a Therapeutic Diet) is a modified diet plan that controls the intake of certain foods, fluids, or nutrients. It is prescribed by a doctor or dietitian as part of the treatment for a medical condition (e.g., diabetes), to manage weight (overweight/underweight), or for personal beliefs (e.g., vegetarianism).

The modifications can include changes in:

- **Consistency:** (e.g., liquid, soft, or high-fibre).
- **Nutrient Content:** (e.g., low-fat, high-protein, low-sodium, controlled carbohydrate).
- **Food Inclusion/Exclusion:** (e.g., gluten-free, vegetarian).

3.2 EXPLAIN THE DIFFERENT TYPES OF VEGETARIAN DIET

Vegetarianism is the practice of abstaining from the consumption of meat (red meat, poultry, seafood, and the flesh of any other animal).

- **Strict/Vegan:** Excludes **all** animal products. This includes meat, poultry, fish, dairy (milk, cheese, yoghurt), eggs, and honey. Vegans also avoid animal by-products like gelatin and leather.
- **Lacto-Ovo Vegetarian:** Excludes all meat, poultry, and fish. **Includes** dairy products (lacto) and eggs (ovo). This is the most common type of vegetarian diet.
- **Lacto Vegetarian:** Excludes all meat, poultry, fish, and eggs. **Includes** dairy products.
- **Ovo Vegetarian:** Excludes all meat, poultry, fish, and dairy. **Includes** eggs.
- **Pescatarian:** Excludes red meat and poultry. **Includes** fish, seafood, dairy, and eggs. (Note: Not technically "vegetarian" as it includes animal flesh, but often grouped with them).
- **Pollotarian:** Excludes red meat and fish. **Includes** poultry (chicken, turkey), dairy, and eggs. (Also not technically vegetarian).

- **Flexitarian:** A semi-vegetarian diet that is largely plant-based but allows for the occasional consumption of meat, poultry, or fish in small quantities.

3.3 DIFFERENTIATE BETWEEN OVERWEIGHT AND UNDERWEIGHT DIET

Feature	Overweight (Weight-Reduction) Diet	Underweight (Weight-Gaining) Diet
Primary Goal	To create a calorie deficit (burn more calories than consumed) for gradual weight loss.	To create a calorie surplus (consume more calories than burned) for gradual weight gain.
Calories	Low-Calorie. Total caloric intake is reduced (e.g., 1200-1800 kcal/day).	High-Calorie. Total caloric intake is increased (e.g., 2500-3500+ kcal/day).
Carbohydrates	Controlled. Focus on complex carbs and high-fibre (e.g., brown rice, oats, vegetables) to promote fullness (satiety). Reduce simple sugars.	High in Carbohydrates. All forms are used for energy, including energy-dense starches and healthy sugars (e.g., pasta, yam, fruits).
Protein	High in Protein. Protein (e.g., lean chicken, fish, beans) is crucial to prevent muscle loss during weight loss and promote satiety.	High in Protein. Protein is essential for building new muscle tissue (e.g., meat, fish, eggs, milk, nuts).
Fats	Low-Fat. Focus on limiting saturated fats. Include small amounts of healthy fats (e.g., avocado, nuts) for satiety.	High in Healthy Fats. Fats are energy-dense (9 kcal/g) and an easy way to add calories (e.g., avocado, nuts, olive oil, groundnuts).
Meal Pattern	3 regular meals, portion-controlled. Avoid skipping meals.	3 large meals + 2-3 high-calorie snacks (e.g., milkshakes, nuts).
Example Meal	Grilled fish with a large portion of steamed vegetables (e.g., uguwu, spinach).	Pounded yam with egusi soup (with extra meat/fish) and a side of avocado.

3.4 DISCUSS DIETS FOR PERSONS SUFFERING FROM...

- **HIV/AIDS:**

- **Goal:** To manage symptoms, maintain a healthy weight, boost the immune system, and cope with the side effects of medications (ARVs).
- **Diet: High-Protein, High-Calorie, Nutrient-Dense.** The body's energy needs are high.
- **Guidelines:**
 - **Protein:** Essential for rebuilding tissue (e.g., eggs, beans, meat, fish).
 - **Calories:** Eat more to prevent "wasting" (weight loss). Add healthy fats and carbs.
 - **Vitamins/Minerals:** Focus on immune-boosting nutrients (Vitamins A, C, E, Zinc, Selenium) found in colourful fruits and vegetables.
 - **Food Safety:** The immune system is weak, so food must be thoroughly cooked and stored. Avoid raw eggs, raw meat, and unpasteurised milk.

- **Fever and Infection:**

- **Goal:** To provide energy to fight the infection, replace fluids lost from sweating, and be easily digestible.
- **Diet: Light, Soft, High-Fluid, High-Calorie.**
- **Guidelines:**
 - **Fluids:** Essential. Water, fruit juices, and light soups (e.g., pepper soup) to prevent dehydration.
 - **Energy:** The body's metabolic rate is high. Provide energy through easily digestible carbs (e.g., pap, custard, rice gruel).
 - **Protein:** For tissue repair (e.g., milk, eggs, fish).
 - **Avoid:** Heavy, oily, and spicy foods, as they are hard to digest.

- **Diarrhoea:**

- **Goal:** To replace lost fluids and electrolytes, and to rest the bowel.
- **Diet: Fluid and Electrolyte Replacement.**
- **Guidelines:**
 - **Fluids: Oral Rehydration Solution (ORS)** (salt, sugar, water) is critical. Also, coconut water, light broths, and rice water.

- **Bland Foods:** As it improves, introduce low-fibre, binding foods (the **BRAT** diet: **B**ananas, **R**ice, **A**pplesauce, **T**oast). Also pap, potatoes.
- **Avoid:** Milk/dairy, oily foods, high-fibre foods (e.g., beans, whole grains), and spicy foods, as they can worsen irritation.
- **Diabetes (Diabetes Mellitus):**
 - **Goal:** To control blood glucose (sugar) levels and maintain a healthy weight.
 - **Diet: Controlled-Carbohydrate, High-Fibre, Low-Sugar, Low-Fat.**
 - **Guidelines:**
 - **Carbs:** Must be controlled and spread throughout the day. Focus on **complex carbs** and **low Glycemic Index (GI)** foods (e.g., brown rice, whole-wheat bread, oats, beans) which release sugar slowly.
 - **Fibre:** Soluble fibre (e.g., oats, okra) helps slow down sugar absorption.
 - **Sugar:** Avoid refined sugars (e.g., soda, sweets, "sugar-added" foods).
 - **Fats:** Limit unhealthy fats to manage heart disease risk, which is high for diabetics.
 - **Portion Control:** Is essential.
- **Ulcer (Peptic Ulcer):**
 - **Goal:** To reduce stomach acid production and avoid irritating the ulcer lining.
 - **Diet: Bland, Non-Irritating, Small Frequent Meals.**
 - **Guidelines:**
 - **Meal Pattern:** Eat 5-6 small meals instead of 3 large ones to prevent the stomach from being too full or too empty.
 - **Foods to Eat:** Soft, bland, and low-acid foods (e.g., pap, moin-moin, boiled yam, rice, eggs, milk, fish, okra).
 - **Foods to AVOID (Irritants):** Spicy foods (pepper), acidic foods (citrus, tomatoes), very oily/fried foods, caffeine (coffee, cola), and alcohol.

EVALUATION

1. What is a therapeutic diet?
2. Differentiate between a "vegan" and a "lacto-ovo vegetarian."
3. Why is a diet for an underweight person high in protein?

4. List three foods an ulcer patient should avoid.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Plan a one-day menu (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner) for a diabetic patient, ensuring you follow the dietary guidelines.
2. Plan a one-day menu (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner) for a lacto vegetarian, ensuring the diet is balanced.



WEEK 4: PRACTICAL ON BEVERAGES AND SPECIAL DIET

4.1 OBJECTIVE

To apply theoretical knowledge by preparing and serving various beverages and dishes suitable for specific special diets.

4.2 PRACTICAL 1: PREPARATION OF BEVERAGES

A. Stimulating Beverage: Brewed Tea

- **Ingredients:** 1 tea bag (or 1 tsp loose tea), 250ml fresh water, milk/sugar (optional).
- **Method:**
 1. Warm a clean teapot by rinsing it with hot water.
 2. Bring fresh water to a rolling boil (100°C).
 3. Place the tea bag in the pot. Pour the boiling water *immediately* over the tea.
 4. Allow to brew (steep) for 3-5 minutes. (Do not "stew" it for too long, as it becomes bitter).
 5. Remove the tea bag.
 6. Serve hot, with milk and sugar offered separately.

B. Nourishing Beverage: Egg Flip

- **Ingredients:** 1 fresh egg, 250ml milk, 1 tbsp sugar, 1/4 tsp vanilla essence, nutmeg (for garnish).
- **Method:**
 1. Wash the eggshell thoroughly. Crack the egg into a small bowl.
 2. In a larger bowl, whisk the egg and sugar together until light and frothy.
 3. Gently warm the milk in a saucepan (do not boil).
 4. Pour the warm milk *slowly* into the egg/sugar mixture, whisking constantly to prevent the egg from scrambling.
 5. Stir in the vanilla essence.
 6. Pour into a glass and grate a small amount of nutmeg on top. Serve warm.

C. Refreshing Beverage: Fresh Pineapple Juice

- **Ingredients:** 1/2 medium pineapple, 1/2 cup water (optional), 1 tsp ginger (optional).
- **Method:**
 1. Wash the pineapple. Peel it, remove the "eyes," and core it.
 2. Cut the pineapple flesh into chunks.
 3. Place the chunks in a blender with the ginger (if using) and a little water to help it blend.
 4. Blend until smooth.
 5. Strain the mixture through a clean muslin cloth or a fine-mesh sieve, squeezing out all the juice.
 6. Chill and serve cold.

4.3 PRACTICAL 2: PREPARATION OF SPECIAL DIET DISHES

A. Dish for Diabetic Patient: Chicken and Vegetable Stir-fry

- **Ingredients:** 1 chicken breast (skinless), 1 cup broccoli, 1 cup carrots (sliced), 1 cup bell peppers (sliced), 1 tbsp soy sauce (low-sodium), 1 tsp sesame oil, 1 clove garlic (minced).
- **Justification:** Low-carb (no staples), high-protein (chicken), high-fibre (vegetables), low-fat (stir-frying in minimal oil).
- **Method:**
 1. Cut the chicken breast into thin strips.
 2. Heat the sesame oil in a wok or large frying pan. Add the garlic and stir-fry for 30 seconds.
 3. Add the chicken strips and stir-fry until cooked through.
 4. Add the "hard" vegetables (carrots, broccoli) and stir-fry for 3-4 minutes.
 5. Add the "soft" vegetables (bell peppers) and soy sauce. Stir-fry for another 1-2 minutes until vegetables are tender-crisp.
 6. Serve hot (can be served with a very small portion of brown rice).

B. Dish for Ulcer Patient: Okra Soup (Bland) with Boiled Yam

- **Ingredients:** 1 cup sliced okra, 1 small piece of boiled fish (flaked), 1/2 cup water or fish stock, 1 tbsp ground crayfish, salt to taste (minimal).
- **Justification:** Bland, non-irritating, and soft. Okra is a "mucilaginous" food, which some find soothing for the stomach lining. Yam is an easily digestible carbohydrate.
- **Method:**
 1. Bring the water/stock to a simmer in a small pot.
 2. Add the flaked fish and ground crayfish. Simmer for 2 minutes.
 3. Add the sliced okra. Stir and cook for 3-5 minutes only (do not overcook).
 4. Add a tiny pinch of salt.
 5. Serve warm with a small portion of soft-boiled white yam.
 6. **Crucially, NO PEPPER and NO PALM OIL are used.**

EVALUATION

1. Why is it important to use *boiling* water for tea?
2. Why is an egg flip considered a "nourishing" beverage?
3. Explain why the Chicken Stir-fry is suitable for a diabetic but the Okra/Yam is not.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write the recipe for a dish suitable for a person on a weight-gaining (underweight) diet. Justify your choice of ingredients.
2. Write the recipe for a dish suitable for a lacto-ovo vegetarian.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

This week is for the Midterm Examination, which will cover all topics from Weeks 1-4.



WEEK 6: CULTURAL FOOD HABIT

6.1 EXPLAIN FOOD HABITS, FOOD TABOOS, FOOD FACTS, AND FOOD FALLACIES

- **Food Habits:** The ways in which individuals or groups select, prepare, consume, and discard food, based on cultural norms, personal preferences, and social traditions. It's *what* we eat, *why* we eat it, and *how* we eat it.
 - *Example:* A common food habit in Southern Nigeria is eating a large "swallow" (like Eba or Pounded Yam) with soup for dinner.
- **Food Taboos:** A cultural or religious prohibition against consuming a certain food. Breaking a taboo is often considered offensive or harmful.
 - *Example:* In many Muslim communities, the consumption of pork is a strong taboo. Some cultures forbid pregnant women from eating snails (a fallacy, see below).
- **Food Facts:** Verifiable, scientifically-proven information about food and its nutritional content or effects on the body.
 - *Example:* "Oranges are a food fact, an excellent source of Vitamin C, which is essential for immune function and preventing scurvy."
- **Food Fallacies (Myths):** Mistaken beliefs, superstitions, or false information about food, often passed down through generations. They are not based on scientific fact.
 - *Example:* "Eating eggs will make a child become a thief." This is a food fallacy.

6.2 ANALYSE THE FACTORS INFLUENCING FOOD HABITS

Food habits are complex and are shaped by many factors:

1. **Geography and Climate:** People traditionally eat what grows locally. Coastal areas (e.g., Niger Delta) eat a lot of fish and seafood. Northern Nigeria (Savannah) eats more grains (millet, sorghum) and livestock.
2. **Religion:** Religion dictates many food practices.
 - **Islam:** Prohibits pork and alcohol; specifies Halal preparation.

- **Christianity (some denominations):** Practice fasting (e.g., Lent, avoiding meat on Fridays).
 - **Hinduism:** Prohibits beef (cows are sacred); many are vegetarian.
3. **Socio-Economic Status:**
- **Wealth:** Wealthier individuals can afford more expensive, diverse, and imported foods (e.g., meat, fresh fruits, processed foods).
 - **Poverty:** Poorer individuals rely on cheaper, staple foods (e.g., cassava, maize), which can lead to malnutrition if not balanced.
4. **Culture and Tradition:** We eat certain foods during festivals (e.g., New Yam Festival, Jollof rice at parties, Moin-Moin at funerals). These foods are part of our identity.
5. **Family and Social Group:** Children learn food habits from their parents. We tend to eat what our friends and partners eat ("social eating").
6. **Media and Advertising:** Television, social media (e.g., Instagram), and adverts heavily influence our food desires, often promoting processed, fast foods.
7. **Personal Beliefs and Knowledge:** Health consciousness, education about nutrition, and personal choices (like becoming a vegetarian) shape our diets.
8. **Psychological Factors:** We eat based on mood (e.g., "comfort food" when sad, "treats" when happy).

6.3 IDENTIFY TRADITIONAL FOODS ASSOCIATED WITH TABOOS

- **Snail:** In some Nigerian cultures, it is taboo for a pregnant woman to eat snail, based on the fallacy that it will make her baby drool or be sluggish.
- **Pork:** A religious taboo for Muslims and some Christian denominations (e.g., Seventh-day Adventists).
- **Dog Meat:** Taboo for the general population in many cultures, but is a traditional delicacy in others (e.g., parts of Cross River).
- **Totem Animals:** In many traditional beliefs, a clan or family may have a "totem" animal (e.g., python, crocodile) that is considered sacred and is taboo to eat.
- **Gizzard:** In some cultures, it was taboo for children or women to eat the gizzard of a chicken; it was reserved exclusively for the male head of the household.

6.4 JUSTIFY FOOD FALLACIES WITH EXAMPLES AND CORRECT FACTS

Food Fallacy (The Myth)	Justification (The Scientific Fact)
1. "Eating eggs will make a child become a thief."	Fact: Eggs have no psychological effect on honesty. They are an excellent, affordable source of high-quality protein, Vitamin D, and choline, which are all essential for a child's growth and brain development.
2. "A pregnant woman eating snails will make her baby sluggish."	Fact: Snails are a very healthy food. They are an excellent source of lean protein, iron, and magnesium. They have no effect on a baby's speed or intelligence.
3. "Drinking garri will make your eyes 'blind' or 'dull'."	Fact: This fallacy likely comes from <i>improperly processed</i> garri (cassava). Cassava contains cyanide , which <i>can</i> cause eye damage (Tropical Ataxic Neuropathy) if not properly fermented and processed. Well-processed garri is safe.
4. "Eating 'heavy' food (like Eba) late at night will make you fat."	Fact: Weight gain is about <i>total daily calorie intake</i> vs. <i>total daily calorie expenditure</i> , not the <i>timing</i> of the meal. However, large meals before bed can cause indigestion and acid reflux.
5. "Brown eggs are more nutritious than white eggs."	Fact: The colour of the eggshell is determined by the breed of the chicken. It has no effect on the nutritional content. The nutrient value (protein, fat, vitamins) is identical.
6. "You must drink 8 glasses of water every day."	Fact: This is an oversimplification. Fluid needs vary based on body size, climate (you need more in Nigeria), and activity level. We also get water from food (fruits, vegetables, soups). The best guide is to drink when you are thirsty.

EVALUATION

1. Differentiate between a "food taboo" and a "food fallacy."
2. List four major factors that can influence a person's food habits.
3. State the scientific fact that corrects the fallacy: "Eating eggs makes children steal."

ASSIGNMENT

1. Interview an older relative (parent or grandparent). Ask them about a food taboo or food fallacy they grew up with.
2. Write a short paragraph describing the taboo/fallacy and then write a second paragraph using your scientific knowledge to explain the "food fact."



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

This week is for the midterm break.



WEEK 8: TRADITIONAL AND FOREIGN DISHES

8.1 EXPLAIN THE TERMS: TRADITIONAL DISHES AND FOREIGN DISHES

- **Traditional Dishes (Indigenous Dishes):** These are foods and dishes that are native to a specific country, region, or ethnic group. They are passed down through generations and are deeply embedded in the local culture and heritage. Their recipes use locally available ingredients and traditional cooking methods.
 - *Characteristics:* Use local staples (yam, cassava, millet), local proteins (bushmeat, snails), local vegetables (ugwu, bitterleaf), and traditional flavourings (crayfish, iru, palm oil).
 - *Example:* Jollof Rice is a traditional West African dish.
- **Foreign Dishes (Exotic Dishes):** These are dishes that originate from a country or culture different from one's own. They are "foreign" to the local cuisine. Due to globalization, many foreign dishes have become popular and adapted worldwide.
 - *Characteristics:* Use ingredients, flavour profiles (herbs, spices), and cooking methods (e.g., stir-frying, baking pasta) that are not native to the region.
 - *Example:* Pizza is a foreign dish in Nigeria, originating from Italy.

8.2 IDENTIFY TRADITIONAL DISHES FROM DIFFERENT LOCALITIES (IN NIGERIA)

- **Yoruba (South-West):**
 - **Amala and Gbegiri/Ewedu:** A combination of black yam flour (Amala) served with a bean soup (Gbegiri) and a jute leaf soup (Ewedu).
 - **Efo Riro:** A rich vegetable soup made with spinach or other greens, palm oil, locust beans (iru), and various meats and fish.
 - **Iyan (Pounded Yam) and Egusi:** Pounded yam served with a soup made from ground melon seeds.
- **Igbo (South-East):**
 - **Akpu (or Fufu) and Ofe Onugbu:** Fermented cassava "swallow" (Akpu) served with a bitterleaf soup (Ofe Onugbu).

- **Nkwobi:** A spicy delicacy of cooked cow's foot (or "cow leg") simmered in a rich, thick palm oil and spice sauce.
- **Ofe Akwu:** A palm nut (banga) stew, often eaten with rice.
- **Hausa/Fulani (North):**
 - **Tuwo Shinkafa and Miyan Kuka:** A soft, mashed rice "swallow" (Tuwo Shinkafa) served with a soup made from dried, ground baobab leaves (Miyan Kuka).
 - **Fura da Nono:** A refreshing drink/meal made from cooked millet balls (Fura) mashed into fermented cow's milk (Nono).
 - **Suya:** Skewered, spiced, and grilled meat, a popular street food.
- **South-South (Niger Delta):**
 - **Banga Soup (Ofe Akwu):** A rich soup made from the extract of palm nuts, popular in Delta/Edo.
 - **Afang Soup:** A vegetable soup made with *Afang* (Okazi) leaves and waterleaf, popular among the Efik/Ibibio.
 - **Edikang Ikong:** A rich, nutritious Efik/Ibibio vegetable soup made with large quantities of waterleaf and ugu.

8.3 ENUMERATE FOREIGN DISHES

- **Italian (European):**
 - **Pizza:** A flat, round base of leavened dough topped with tomato sauce, cheese, and various other ingredients, baked at a high temperature.
 - **Pasta:** Dishes made from durum wheat flour, such as Spaghetti Bolognese (pasta with meat sauce) or Lasagna (layered pasta sheets with cheese and sauce).
- **Chinese (Asian):**
 - **Fried Rice:** Cooked rice stir-fried in a wok with other ingredients such as eggs, vegetables, and small pieces of meat or shrimp.
 - **Spring Rolls:** A pastry wrapper filled with minced vegetables and/or meat, rolled, and deep-fried.
- **Indian (Asian):**

- **Curry:** A variety of dishes originating in the Indian subcontinent, characterized by a complex combination of spices and herbs, usually including turmeric, cumin, and coriander, cooked with meat or vegetables in a rich sauce.
- **Naan Bread:** A leavened, oven-baked (traditionally in a tandoor) flatbread.
- **American (North American):**
 - **Hamburger (Burger):** A sandwich consisting of a cooked patty of ground meat (usually beef) placed inside a sliced bread roll or bun.
 - **Apple Pie:** A dessert pie in which the principal filling ingredient is apple.
- **Japanese (Asian):**
 - **Sushi:** A dish of prepared vinegared rice, usually with some sugar and salt, accompanying a variety of ingredients, such as seafood (often raw) and vegetables.
 - **Teriyaki:** A cooking technique in which foods are broiled or grilled with a glaze of soy sauce, mirin, and sugar.
- **British (European):**
 - **Fish and Chips:** A hot dish consisting of battered, deep-fried fish, served with deep-fried potato "chips."

EVALUATION

1. Explain the main difference between a traditional dish and a foreign dish.
2. Name one traditional dish from each of the three major ethnic groups in Nigeria (Hausa, Igbo, Yoruba).
3. List three foreign dishes and their country of origin.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Ask your parents for the recipe of your family's favourite traditional dish. Write down the ingredients and the step-by-step method.
2. Choose one foreign dish (e.g., Pizza). Research its main ingredients and briefly explain why it is popular in Nigeria today.

WEEK 9: PRACTICAL ON TRADITIONAL AND FOREIGN DISHES

9.1 OBJECTIVE

To apply knowledge by preparing and serving one representative Nigerian traditional dish and one popular foreign dish.

9.2 PRACTICAL 1: TRADITIONAL DISH (EFO RIRO)

- **Dish:** Efo Riro (Yoruba Vegetable Soup)
- **Justification:** A popular and nutritious soup from South-West Nigeria, showcasing traditional ingredients like palm oil, locust beans, and local greens.
- **Ingredients:**
 - 1 large bunch of Efo Shoko or Ugwu (spinach can be a substitute)
 - Assorted meat and fish (e.g., beef, shaki, pomo, smoked fish)
 - 1/2 cup palm oil
 - 1 cup blended pepper mix (tatashe, rodo, onion)
 - 2 tbsp ground crayfish
 - 1 tbsp locust beans (Iru)
 - Stock cubes and salt to taste
- **Method:**
 1. Wash and cut the vegetables. Blanch them in hot, salted water for 1 minute, drain, and set aside.
 2. Wash and boil the assorted meats until tender, reserving the stock.
 3. Heat the palm oil in a pot for 1-2 minutes (do not bleach). Add the Iru and fry for 30 seconds.
 4. Add the blended pepper mix and fry until the oil rises to the top (about 10-15 minutes).
 5. Add the boiled meats, smoked fish, crayfish, and stock cubes. Stir and let it simmer for 10 minutes for the flavours to combine.
 6. Add the blanched vegetables. Stir gently to combine.

7. Cook for another 3-5 minutes (do not overcook the vegetables). Taste and add salt if needed.
8. Serve hot with Eba, Pounded Yam, or Amala.

9.3 PRACTICAL 2: FOREIGN DISH (CHINESE-STYLE FRIED RICE)

- **Dish:** Fried Rice
- **Justification:** A popular foreign dish from China that has been widely adopted in Nigeria, especially at parties. It demonstrates the stir-frying technique.
- **Ingredients:**
 - 2 cups cooked, cold rice (leftover rice is best)
 - 1 cup mixed vegetables (diced carrots, peas, sweet corn)
 - 100g chicken breast or shrimp (diced)
 - 2 eggs
 - 3 tbsp soy sauce
 - 1 tbsp vegetable oil
 - 1 clove garlic, minced (optional)
- **Method:**
 1. Heat a wok or large frying pan with the oil. Add the garlic and stir-fry for 30 seconds.
 2. Add the diced chicken/shrimp and stir-fry until cooked.
 3. Push the chicken to one side of the wok. Crack the eggs onto the empty side and scramble them.
 4. Add the mixed vegetables and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes.
 5. Add the cold, cooked rice. Use a spoon to break up any clumps.
 6. Stir-fry everything together, tossing the rice to heat it through (about 5 minutes).
 7. Add the soy sauce and mix well until all the rice is evenly coloured.
 8. Serve hot.

EVALUATION

1. What is the purpose of blanching the vegetables for Efo Riro?

2. Why is it better to use *cold* rice for making fried rice?
3. What traditional ingredient in Efo Riro gives it its unique aroma?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write the recipe for a simple foreign dessert (e.g., pancakes or a fruit salad).
2. Write the recipe for a traditional "swallow" (e.g., Eba or Semovita) that could be served with the Efo Riro.



WEEK 10: ART OF ENTERTAINMENT

10.1 EXPLAIN THE TERM ENTERTAINMENT

Entertainment, in the context of food and nutrition, is the art of **hospitality**. It involves receiving and providing food, drink, and a welcoming atmosphere for guests. It is a social activity that ranges from a simple, informal invitation for coffee to a large, formal and elaborate event like a wedding reception.

10.2 DISCUSS STEPS IN ORGANISING A PARTY

Organising a successful party or event requires careful planning. The steps can be broken down as follows:

1. Planning Stage (The "Why, Who, Where, When"):

- **Purpose:** Why are you having the party? (e.g., birthday, graduation, holiday). This determines the style.
- **Budget:** How much can you afford to spend? This is the most important factor and controls all other decisions.
- **Date and Time:** Choose a date and time convenient for you and your main guests.
- **Guest List:** Decide *who* to invite and *how many*. This affects the budget and venue.
- **Venue:** Where will it be held? (e.g., home, garden, rented hall). Ensure it's suitable for the number of guests and the event type.
- **Theme:** Decide on a theme or level of formality (e.g., casual BBQ, formal dinner).

2. Preparation Stage (The "What and How"):

- **Invitations:** Send out invitations (print, email, or digital) with clear information (Date, Time, Venue, Purpose, RSVP, Dress code).
- **Menu Planning:** Plan a menu that suits the theme, time of day, and budget. Include drinks, starters, main courses, and desserts. (e.g., don't serve Eba at a cocktail party).
- **Shopping:** Make a detailed shopping list for food, drinks, and decorations. Buy non-perishable items in advance.

- **Equipment:** Check that you have enough plates, cutlery, glasses, and serving dishes. Arrange to borrow or hire if needed.
- **Decorations:** Plan and purchase decorations that match the theme.
- **Help:** Arrange for help with cooking, serving, or cleaning if needed.

3. Execution Stage (The "Event Day"):

- **Food Preparation:** Start cooking, following a clear timeline. Prepare cold dishes first.
- **Setup:** Set the table(s), arrange decorations, and set up a drink station.
- **Host/Hostess Role:** Welcome guests, make introductions, serve food and drinks, and ensure everyone is comfortable.
- **Manage:** Keep an eye on the food supply, clear empty plates, and manage the "flow" of the party.

4. Post-Party Stage (The "Cleanup"):

- **Cleanup:** Clear, wash dishes, and store leftover food safely.
- **Thank-Yous:** Thank guests for coming and for any gifts received.
- **Review:** (Personal) Think about what went well and what could be improved for next time.

10.3 JUSTIFY THE DIFFERENT TYPES OF PARTIES

Parties are justified by their specific social function, purpose, and level of formality.

Type of Party	Justification (Purpose, Style, and Food Served)
Birthday Party	Purpose: To celebrate the anniversary of a person's birth. Style: Can be casual (for kids) or formal. Food: Cake is essential; menu ranges from snacks to a full meal.
Surprise Party	Purpose: A birthday or anniversary party where the guest of honour is unaware of the event. Style: Informal and celebratory. Food: Usually buffet-style or finger foods, as guests arrive at different times.
Dinner Party	Purpose: A formal or semi-formal social gathering where guests are invited for dinner. Style: Seated, in the evening. Food: A multi-course meal (e.g., starter, main, dessert) served at the table.

Garden Party	Purpose: A social event held outdoors in a garden or park. Style: Usually semi-formal, held in the afternoon. Food: Light foods, sandwiches, cakes, and drinks like lemonade or tea.
Cocktail Party	Purpose: A short, sophisticated gathering (e.g., 6-8 pm) before a main event, or as a networking event. Style: Formal, guests stand and mingle. Food: No meal. "Finger foods" (canapés) and alcoholic/non-alcoholic cocktails are served.
Tea Party	Purpose: A light social event in the late afternoon. Style: Can be formal ("high tea") or informal. Food: Scones, small sandwiches, cakes, pastries, and a variety of teas and coffee.
Reception	Purpose: A formal party to welcome guests, typically after a major event like a wedding , funeral, or official ceremony. Style: Formal. Food: Can be a full seated meal or a standing buffet.
Costume Party	Purpose: A fun, informal party where guests dress up according to a specific theme. Style: Informal, celebratory. Food: Usually casual buffet, snacks, and drinks.
Christmas Caroling	Purpose: A social gathering during the Christmas season that involves singing carols. Style: Informal, festive. Food: Warm drinks (like hot chocolate), and Christmas treats (like mince pies, cookies).
Pool Party	Purpose: A casual party held at a swimming pool. Style: Very informal. Food: Casual, "hand-held" food like grilled items (BBQ), sandwiches, and cold drinks.
Fundraising Party	Purpose: To raise money for a charity, cause, or project. Style: Can be formal (a gala dinner) or informal (a bake sale). Food: The food is often part of the "ticket price" to raise funds.
Graduation Party	Purpose: To celebrate a person's academic achievement. Style: Can be casual (open house) or formal. Food: Often a buffet to accommodate guests coming and going.
Housewarming	Purpose: To celebrate moving into a new home. Style: Usually informal. Food: Casual buffet or "potluck" (where guests bring a dish).
Welcome/Farewell	Purpose: To welcome a new person (e.g., new colleague) or say goodbye

	to someone leaving. Style: Varies. Food: Can be a simple tea party at work or a full dinner.
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EVALUATION

1. What is the "art of entertainment"?
2. List the four main stages of organizing a party.
3. What is the main difference in food served at a "Cocktail Party" versus a "Dinner Party"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. You are planning a small surprise 16th birthday party for 10 friends. (a) List 5 food items and 2 drinks you would serve. (b) Write a short "shopping list" for your menu. (c) Write a sample invitation text (e.g., for WhatsApp).



WEEK 11: TABLE SETTING AND ETIQUETTE

11.1 EXPLAIN THE TERMS: HOST/HOSTESS, GUEST, WAITER/WAITRESS

- **Host/Hostess:** The person who invites and receives guests at their home or at an event. They are responsible for the planning, provision of food and drink, and the overall comfort of the guests.
- **Guest:** A person who is invited to visit someone's home or attend a social event. They are the recipient of the host's hospitality.
- **Waiter/Waitress:** A professional (male/waiter or female/waitress) whose job is to take orders and serve food and beverages to customers in a restaurant, hotel, or at a formal event.

11.2 DISCUSS THE QUALITIES OF A GOOD HOST/HOSTESS, GUEST, WAITER/WAITRESS

Qualities of a Good Host/Hostess:

- **Welcoming:** Greets all guests warmly at the door.
- **Organised:** Has planned well so they are not stressed and can spend time with guests.
- **Attentive:** Observes guests' needs (e.g., refilling drinks, ensuring they have food).
- **Sociable:** Makes introductions, stimulating conversation and helping shy guests mingle.
- **Considerate:** Has taken guests' dietary needs (allergies, preferences) into account.
- **Gracious:** Remains calm and polite even if things go wrong (e.g., a dish burns).

Qualities of a Good Guest:

- **Punctual:** Arrives on time, or slightly (10-15 mins) *after* the stated time for a home party (not early).
- **Polite:** Greets the host and other guests politely.
- **RSVP:** Responds to the invitation promptly to let the host know if they are coming.
- **Appreciative:** Thanks the host when leaving and (optionally) brings a small gift (e.g., a bottle of wine, chocolates).

- **Helpful:** Offers to help (e.g., clear plates), but does not insist if the host declines.
- **Sociable:** Mingles and makes an effort to talk to other guests.

Qualities of a Good Waiter/Waitress:

- **Professional:** Has a clean and neat uniform/appearance.
- **Hygienic:** Practices good personal hygiene (clean hands, hair tied back).
- **Knowledgeable:** Knows the menu, ingredients, and can make recommendations.
- **Attentive:** Is observant and can anticipate customer needs (e.g., refilling water) without being intrusive.
- **Efficient:** Takes orders accurately, serves food promptly, and works quickly.
- **Polite:** Is courteous, patient, and has a pleasant attitude.

11.3 EXPLAIN THE TERMS: TABLE SETTING AND TABLE ETIQUETTE

- **Table Setting (Laying the Table):** The act of arranging the tableware (plates, cutlery, glassware, napkins) on the table in their correct positions for a meal. The complexity of the setting depends on the formality of the meal.
- **Table Etiquette (Table Manners):** The set of rules of polite and correct behaviour to be observed when eating at a table. Following these rules shows respect for the host and other diners.

11.4 DIFFERENTIATE BETWEEN FORMAL AND INFORMAL TABLE SETTING

Feature	Informal Setting (e.g., Family Dinner)	Formal Setting (e.g., Wedding, Fine Dining)
Overall Look	Simple, practical.	Elaborate, elegant, and symmetrical.
Table Cover	Placemats, or a simple tablecloth.	A high-quality, pressed tablecloth, often with a "silence cloth" underneath.
Plates	A main plate (or charger) is set.	Charger (Service Plate): A large decorative plate that stays on the table. A Side Plate (for bread) is placed to the top-

		left.
Cutlery	Basic. Main fork (left), main knife (right), soup spoon (right of knife). Dessert spoon/fork may be at the top or brought later.	Multiple. Arranged in "outside-in" order. E.g., (Left): Salad fork, Dinner fork. (Right): Soup spoon, Salad knife, Dinner knife. Dessert cutlery is at the top.
Glassware	One glass, usually for water, placed at the top-right.	Multiple glasses. Water glass, red wine glass, white wine glass, arranged in order of use.
Napkin	Paper or simple cloth, placed on the plate or to the left.	High-quality cloth, folded elaborately, and placed on the charger or in the centre.
Extras	Salt & pepper shakers.	Centrepiece (flowers), place cards, individual salt & pepper cellars.

11.5 DEMONSTRATE TABLE SETTING (DESCRIPTION OF A FORMAL SETTING)

1. **Centre:** Place the charger (service plate) in the centre of the setting, 1 inch from the edge of the table.
2. **Left of Plate (Forks):** Arrange forks in order of use, from the outside-in. E.g., small salad fork (outside), large dinner fork (inside, next to plate).
3. **Right of Plate (Knives/Spoons):** Arrange from the inside-out. E.g., dinner knife (inside, blade facing plate), salad knife, soup spoon (outside).
4. **Top of Plate (Dessert):** Place the dessert spoon (handle right) and dessert fork (handle left) horizontally above the plate.
5. **Top Left (Bread):** Place the small bread plate, with a small butter knife laid horizontally across it.
6. **Top Right (Glasses):** Place the water glass directly above the main knife. To its right, place the white wine glass, and then the red wine glass.
7. **Napkin:** Place the folded napkin on top of the charger plate.

11.6 HIGHLIGHT TABLE MANNERS AND ETIQUETTE (DOS AND DON'TS)

DO:

- **Wait:** Wait for the host (or eldest person) to start eating before you begin.
- **Napkin:** Place your napkin on your lap as soon as you are seated. If you leave, place it on your chair. When finished, place it loosely (not re-folded) to the left of your plate.
- **Cutlery:** Use cutlery from the "outside-in" for each course.
- **Chew:** Chew with your mouth **closed** and do not talk with food in your mouth.
- **Soup:** Spoon soup *away* from your body. Tip the bowl away from you to get the last bit.
- **Passing:** Ask for items to be passed to you ("Please pass the salt"). Do not reach across other guests. Pass salt and pepper together.
- **Pace:** Eat at a moderate pace, keeping up with the host and other guests.
- **Signal:** When finished, place your knife and fork (tines down) together on the plate in the "4 o'clock" position.

DON'T:

- **Elbows:** Do not rest your elbows on the table while eating (forearms are acceptable).
- **Noise:** Do not slurp soup, smack your lips, or make loud eating noises.
- **Gulp:** Do not gulp your drink.
- **Phone:** Do not place your phone on the table. Do not text or take calls.
- **Grooming:** Do not pick your teeth, comb your hair, or apply makeup at the table.
- **Reach:** Do not reach over someone's plate.
- **Gesture:** Do not gesture or point with your cutlery.
- **Criticise:** Do not criticise the food, even if you do not like it.

EVALUATION

1. List three qualities of a good guest.
2. What is the main difference between an informal and a formal table setting regarding cutlery?
3. Where should you place your napkin if you temporarily leave the table?
4. What is the "outside-in" rule for cutlery?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a simple diagram of a *formal* table setting. Label the following: Dinner Plate, Dinner Fork, Dinner Knife, Soup Spoon, Water Glass, and Side (Bread) Plate.
2. List five "Don'ts" of table etiquette.



WEEK 12: REVISION

- This week will be dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the term, in preparation for the final examination.
- **Key Topics:**
 - **Beverages:** Classification (alcoholic/non-alcoholic), types (stimulating, refreshing, nourishing), nutritive value.
 - **Special Diets:** Definition, types of vegetarianism, diets for weight management, and therapeutic diets (Diabetes, Ulcer, HIV, Fever).
 - **Cultural Food Habits:** Definitions (habits, taboos, facts, fallacies), factors influencing habits, and scientific facts vs. myths.
 - **Traditional vs. Foreign Dishes:** Definitions and examples from Nigeria and around the world.
 - **Entertainment:** The 4 stages of party planning, types of parties.
 - **Table Setting & Etiquette:** Roles (host, guest), formal vs. informal setting, and table manners.
- Students should review all notes, assignments, and practical guides.

SS3 FOOD AND NUTRITION LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: WELCOME TEST & FOOD SERVICE

1.1 WELCOME TEST

This session will begin with a short test (questions and answers) to review key topics from the First Term, including:

- Types of Beverages (Alcoholic/Non-Alcoholic, Stimulating, Nourishing).
- Special Diets (Vegetarianism, Diabetic, Ulcer, etc.).
- Cultural Food Habits (Taboos, Fallacies, Facts).
- Traditional vs. Foreign Dishes.
- The Art of Entertainment and Table Setting.

1.2 EXPLAIN FOOD SERVICE

Food Service (or Catering Service) is the comprehensive process of planning, preparing, presenting, and serving food and beverages to a customer or guest. It encompasses all activities from the initial menu design to the final clearing of tables. It is a major part of the hospitality industry.

1.3 DIFFERENTIATE BETWEEN FORMAL AND INFORMAL FOOD SERVICE

Food service is broadly divided based on the level of elaboration, service style, cost, and guest-staff interaction.

Feature	Formal Food Service	Informal Food Service
Atmosphere	Sophisticated, elegant, strict.	Casual, relaxed, and laid-back.
Service Staff	Highly trained, professional waiters/waitresses. High staff-to-guest ratio.	Fewer staff, often self-service or counter-service.
Menu	Elaborate, multi-course (e.g., 5-7 courses),	Simple, often pre-prepared,

	often <i>à la carte</i> or <i>table d'hôte</i> .	limited choices.
Table Setting	Very elaborate: multiple sets of cutlery (silverware), glassware, fine china, tablecloths.	Simple: basic cutlery, single glass, placemats or bare table.
Service Style	Food is served <i>to</i> the guest at the table by staff. (e.g., Silver Service, Gueridon Service).	Guests often serve themselves or collect food from a counter.
Cost	Very expensive.	Inexpensive to moderately priced.
Examples	Fine dining restaurants, state banquets, high-end hotel restaurants.	Cafeterias, fast-food restaurants, home dining, canteens, buffet.

1.4 ANALYSE DIFFERENT TYPES OF INFORMAL SERVICE

Informal service prioritizes convenience, speed, and cost-effectiveness.

1. Buffet Service:

- **Description:** A popular method for large gatherings (parties, receptions). Food is arranged attractively on long tables (a "buffet line"). Guests walk along the line and serve themselves.
- **Pros:** Guests have a wide choice, can control portion sizes, and service is relatively fast.
- **Cons:** Can lead to food waste, potential for food contamination if not monitored, requires large space.

2. Cafeteria Service:

- **Description:** Common in schools, hospitals, and canteens. Guests slide a tray along a counter. They either select pre-portioned items (e.g., salads, desserts) or are served by staff from Bain-maries (hot food containers). They pay at the end of the counter.
- **Pros:** Very fast for large numbers, good portion control, low staff cost.
- **Cons:** Perceived as "institutional," limited menu choices.

3. Counter Service / Takeaway:

- **Description:** The customer orders, pays, and receives their food at a single counter. This is the model for fast-food restaurants. Food is often packaged "to-go."
 - **Pros:** Extremely fast, low cost, high customer turnover.
 - **Cons:** Highly impersonal, menu is standardized and not flexible.
4. **Family Service:**
- **Description:** This is the service style used in most homes. Food is placed on the table in large serving dishes, and family members pass the dishes around to serve themselves.
 - **Pros:** Very intimate, relaxed, and encourages social interaction.
 - **Cons:** Not practical for large, non-family groups.
5. **Tray Service:**
- **Description:** The entire meal is pre-portioned and arranged on a tray, which is then delivered to the guest.
 - **Use:** This is not common in restaurants but is the standard for hospitals, airlines, and hotel room service.
 - **Pros:** Very convenient for the guest, good for feeding people in-situ.
 - **Cons:** Food quality can suffer, limited menu.
6. **Vending Machine Service:**
- **Description:** An automated service where guests insert money and select a pre-packaged item (e.g., drinks, snacks, sandwiches) from a machine.
 - **Pros:** Available 24/7, zero staff cost.
 - **Cons:** Very limited (pre-packaged food only), risk of machine malfunction.

1.5 JUSTIFY THE IMPORTANCE OF FOOD SERVICE

The food service industry is a vital part of the economy and society.

1. **Customer Satisfaction:** The primary goal. Good service provides a pleasant and satisfying experience, encouraging repeat business.
2. **Employment:** It is a massive global employer, providing jobs for chefs, waiters, managers, cleaners, and suppliers.

3. **Economic Contribution:** It generates significant revenue for the economy through sales, taxes, and tourism.
4. **Hygiene and Safety:** It upholds public health standards by implementing food safety practices.
5. **Social Hub:** Restaurants and canteens act as social hubs where people meet, interact, and celebrate.
6. **Convenience and Nutrition:** It provides nourishment for people who are away from home, such as workers in canteens, children in schools, and patients in hospitals.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between formal and informal service regarding staff?
2. List three types of informal food service.
3. A school canteen where students line up with a tray is an example of which service type?
4. State two reasons why the food service industry is important.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Describe the type of food service you would recommend for a wedding reception with 300 guests. Justify your choice with two advantages.
2. Observe a fast-food restaurant (e.g., Mr. Bigg's, Tantalizers). Write a short paragraph describing the "counter service" system in action.

WEEK 2: SELF EMPLOYMENT (CATERING ENTERPRISE)

2.1 EXPLAIN THE TERMS: ENTREPRENEUR, ENTREPRENEURSHIP, ENTERPRISE

- **Entrepreneur:** An **individual** who identifies a business opportunity, takes on the financial **risk** (using their own or borrowed money), and assumes full responsibility for starting, owning, and managing a new business venture. They are innovators and risk-bearers.
 - *Example:* The woman who starts her own "Small Chops" delivery business.
- **Entrepreneurship:** This is the **process** or **act** of being an entrepreneur. It is the dynamic process of creating, designing, launching, and running a new business. It involves all the steps from having the idea to managing the day-to-day operations.
 - *Example:* The *act* of writing a business plan, securing a loan, and registering the "Small Chops" business.
- **Enterprise:** This is the **outcome** of entrepreneurship; it is the **business venture itself**. An enterprise is the project or company that is created, such as a shop, a factory, or a catering company.
 - *Example:* The "Small Chops" business, once it is operating, is the enterprise.

2.2 DISCUSS THE CHARACTERISTICS OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP (AND AN ENTREPRENEUR)

Successful entrepreneurs often share a set of key characteristics:

1. **Risk-Taker:** Willing to risk their own time and money on an idea that may or may not succeed.
2. **Innovator/Creative:** Able to identify new opportunities, create new products, or find new ways of doing things.
3. **Persistent and Resilient:** Does not give up easily when faced with challenges or failures.
4. **Hard-Working (Committed):** Willing to work long hours to ensure the business succeeds.
5. **Independent:** Has a strong desire to be their own boss and make their own decisions.

6. **Goal-Oriented:** Can set clear, achievable goals and work systematically towards them.
7. **Good Leader and Manager:** Able to motivate and manage staff effectively.
8. **Decisive:** Can make quick and effective decisions, even under pressure.

2.3 STATE ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Advantages:

1. **Independence:** You are your own boss. You control your own schedule, vision, and decisions.
2. **Direct Financial Reward:** You get to keep all the profits (after costs and taxes). Your potential for wealth is not limited by a fixed salary.
3. **Self-Fulfillment:** There is great personal satisfaction in building a successful business from your own idea.
4. **Job Creation:** You create employment opportunities for other people in your community.
5. **Flexibility:** You can often (though not always) set your own work hours.
6. **Directly Use Your Skills:** A trained caterer can directly use their passion and skills, not just work for someone else.

Disadvantages:

1. **High Financial Risk:** You can lose all the money you invested if the business fails. You may have to take on large debts.
2. **Long Working Hours:** Entrepreneurs, especially in the beginning, often work much longer hours (evenings, weekends) than regular employees.
3. **Full Responsibility:** You are responsible for *everything* – paying staff, fixing broken equipment, customer complaints, paying bills. This can be highly stressful.
4. **Financial Insecurity:** Income can be unstable, especially in the first few years. There is no guaranteed monthly salary.
5. **High Level of Stress:** The pressure to succeed, manage finances, and handle all problems can be immense.

2.4 IDENTIFY FACTORS CONTRIBUTING TO THE SUCCESS OF AN ENTERPRISE

Many businesses fail in their first few years. Success often depends on these factors:

1. **A Good Business Plan:** A clear, well-researched plan that outlines your goals, costs, and marketing strategy.
2. **Adequate Capital (Funding):** Enough money to start the business *and* cover operating costs for the first 6-12 months until it becomes profitable.
3. **Good Management Skills:** Knowing how to manage money (financial management), staff (human resources), and time.
4. **A Good Product/Service:** The food must be high-quality, tasty, and consistent.
5. **The Right Location:** The business must be visible, accessible, and in an area with enough customers (e.g., a canteen near a busy office park).
6. **Effective Marketing:** People need to *know* your business exists. (e.g., social media, flyers, word-of-mouth).
7. **Good Record Keeping:** Accurately tracking all sales, costs, and expenses to know if you are making a profit or loss.
8. **Adaptability:** Being willing to change your menu or service based on customer feedback and market trends.

2.5 DISCUSS HOW TO SET UP A CATERING ENTERPRISE (A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE)

1. **Develop the Idea & Niche:** Decide *what* kind of catering you will do. You cannot do everything.
 - *Niche examples:* Small chops & cocktails, children's party food, wedding cakes, corporate (office) lunch delivery, traditional event catering.
2. **Conduct a Feasibility Study & Write a Business Plan:**
 - **Research:** Who are your competitors? Who are your target customers? What will they pay?
 - **Write the Plan:** Include your menu, pricing, marketing plan, and financial projections (startup costs, expected profit).
3. **Source Capital:**

- Personal savings, loans from family/friends, bank loans (e.g., from Bank of Industry), or government grants.
4. **Handle Legal & Registration:**
- Register your business name with the **Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC)**.
 - Get a **Food Handler's Certificate** (from the Ministry of Health).
 - You may need **NAFDAC** approval if you are pre-packaging food items for sale.
 - Register for taxes (e.g., with the FIRS).
5. **Find a Location and Set Up:**
- Rent a suitable shop or kitchen space. It must have access to clean water and good sanitation.
 - Purchase or rent essential equipment (cookers, fridges, freezers, pots, pans, utensils).
6. **Hire and Train Staff (if needed):**
- Hire cooks, cleaners, or delivery staff.
 - Train them in your recipes and, crucially, in food hygiene.
7. **Develop Your Menu and Find Suppliers:**
- Finalise your menu and calculate the cost of each dish.
 - Find reliable suppliers in the market for your ingredients.
8. **Market and Launch:**
- Start advertising. Print flyers, create an Instagram/Facebook page, tell friends and family.
 - Offer promotions to get your first customers.

EVALUATION

1. In one sentence each, define entrepreneur, entrepreneurship, and enterprise.
2. List three advantages and three disadvantages of being an entrepreneur.
3. What is the purpose of a "Feasibility Study"?
4. Why is "Good Record Keeping" essential for a successful business?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Imagine you want to start a small catering business. (a) Choose a specific "niche" (e.g., baking cakes, home lunch delivery, etc.). (b) List five key pieces of equipment you would need to buy first. (c) Describe one way you would market your new business.



WEEK 3: SELF EMPLOYMENT (WORK ETHICS AND FOOD PACKAGING)

3.1 WORK ETHICS AND FOOD PACKAGING

- **Work Ethics:** A set of moral principles, values, and standards of conduct that guide an individual's behaviour in their professional life. It is the belief in the moral benefit of work and its ability to build character. In simple terms, it's about being a good, responsible, and professional worker.
- **Food Packaging:** The science, art, and technology of enclosing or protecting food for distribution, storage, sale, and use. It involves designing and producing the container (e.g., bottle, box, sachet, can) for a food product.

3.2 GOOD WORK ETHICS

In the catering and food service industry, good work ethics are non-negotiable.

1. **Punctuality:** Arriving at work on time or early. In catering, if the cook is late, the entire service fails.
2. **Honesty and Integrity:**
 - Not stealing food, supplies, or money.
 - Giving customers the correct change.
 - Being truthful about ingredients (e.g., in case of allergies).
3. **Hygiene (Personal and Food):** This is a primary work ethic in catering.
 - Coming to work clean (bathed, in a clean uniform).
 - Washing hands constantly.
 - Following all food safety rules (e.g., not cross-contaminating).
4. **Professionalism:**
 - Maintaining a neat appearance (clean apron, hair tied back or in a net).
 - Using polite language (no "gbe-gbe" in the kitchen or with customers).
 - Treating customers and colleagues with respect.
5. **Accountability:**
 - Taking responsibility for your tasks and your mistakes.

- If you burn the rice, you admit it, apologize, and start fixing the problem. You don't blame someone else.
6. **Teamwork and Cooperation:**
- A kitchen is a team. You must be willing to help colleagues when they are busy ("Help me chop these onions!").
7. **Commitment and Hard Work:**
- Doing your job thoroughly and efficiently without cutting corners.
 - Staying focused on the task.

3.3 REASONS FOR PACKAGING FOOD

Packaging is much more than just a container; it serves many critical functions.

1. **Protection and Preservation:** This is the primary reason. It protects the food from:
 - **Physical damage** (e.g., prevents eggs from breaking).
 - **Environmental factors** (e.g., moisture, air, light, which cause spoilage).
 - **Contamination** (e.g., from bacteria, pests, dust, chemicals).
 - This extends the **shelf life** of the food.
2. **Containment:** To hold the food together in one place for easy handling (e.g., a bottle for juice, a bag for garri).
3. **Information and Labeling:** The package provides a place to print essential information for the consumer:
 - Brand name, product name.
 - List of ingredients.
 - Nutritional information table.
 - "Best Before" or "Expiry" date.
 - NAFDAC registration number.
4. **Marketing and Attraction:** The design, colours, and logo on the package attract the customer's attention and persuade them to buy the product. It is a "silent salesman."
5. **Convenience:** Packaging makes the food easier to transport, store, and use.
 - *Examples:* Single-serving sachets of tomato paste, re-sealable bags of cereal, microwavable containers.

6. **Security:** Packaging can have tamper-evident seals (e.g., a cap on a bottle) so the customer knows it has not been opened.

3.4 TYPES AND QUALITIES OF PACKAGING MATERIALS

Types of Packaging Materials:

1. **Glass (e.g., bottles for drinks, jars for jam):**

- **Justification (Pros):** Excellent barrier (impermeable to air/moisture), transparent (customer can see food), inert (doesn't react with food), recyclable.
- **Cons:** Heavy, breakable, and more expensive.

2. **Plastic (e.g., bottles, films/wraps, tubs, sachets):**

- **Justification (Pros):** Very lightweight, versatile (can be rigid or flexible), low cost, shatterproof.
- **Cons:** Can be bad for the environment (pollution), some types can leach chemicals into food (must be "food-grade").

3. **Paper and Cardboard (e.g., boxes for cereal, bags for flour, takeaway packs):**

- **Justification (Pros):** Lightweight, cheap, biodegradable/recyclable, good for printing.
- **Cons:** Not waterproof (unless coated), not strong, poor barrier against moisture and air.

4. **Metal (e.g., aluminium cans for soda, steel cans for tomatoes, foil):**

- **Justification (Pros):** Excellent barrier (blocks 100% of light, air, water), very strong, good for long-term preservation (canning).
- **Cons:** Heavier than plastic, can be expensive, cans can rust if damaged.

5. **Traditional/Natural (e.g., Banana leaves, Uwa leaves for Moin-Moin):**

- **Justification (Pros):** Biodegradable, cheap, and can add a subtle, desirable flavour to the food.
- **Cons:** Very poor barrier, short-term use only, not suitable for commercial distribution.

Qualities of Good Packaging Material:

- **Food-Grade and Non-Toxic:** Must not contain any chemicals that can leach into the food and cause harm.
- **Good Barrier Properties:** Must protect the food from air, moisture, light, or microbes, as required.
- **Durable:** Must be strong enough to withstand transportation and handling without breaking or tearing.
- **Appropriate for the Food:** Must be suitable for the food (e.g., liquid-proof for drinks, grease-proof for oily foods).
- **Cost-Effective:** The cost of the package should not be excessively high relative to the cost of the food.
- **Easy to Use:** Should be easy for the consumer to open, and ideally, to re-seal.

EVALUATION

1. Define "work ethics."
2. List three work ethics that are particularly important in a kitchen.
3. State the five main reasons for packaging food.
4. What is a major advantage of using glass as a packaging material? What is a major disadvantage?
5. What is the main advantage of using traditional leaves for packaging Moin-Moin?

ASSIGNMENT

1. You are going to sell homemade cookies at your school's sports day. (a) Choose a packaging material (e.g., plastic bags, paper bags, plastic tub). (b) Justify your choice, explaining why it is suitable for cookies based on the "Qualities of Good Packaging."

WEEK 4: EXPERIMENTAL COOKERY

4.1 RECIPE

A **recipe** is a set of instructions for preparing a particular dish. It is a formula that lists the necessary **ingredients**, their **quantities** or **proportions**, and a step-by-step **method** of combining and cooking them. A good recipe ensures that the dish will be consistent and successful every time it is made.

4.2 IDENTIFY SOURCES OF COLLECTING INFORMATION ON RECIPES

Recipe information can be collected from a wide variety of sources:

- **Primary Sources (Direct):**
 - **Family and Friends:** Passed down orally from parents, grandparents, or relatives. This is the source of most traditional recipes.
 - **Personal Experimentation (Trial and Error):** Creating a new dish from scratch by testing different ingredients and methods.
- **Secondary Sources (Recorded):**
 - **Cookbooks:** Books dedicated to recipes.
 - **Magazines and Newspapers:** Food sections or columns.
 - **The Internet:**
 - Food blogs (e.g., Sisi Yemmie, All Nigerian Recipes).
 - Recipe websites (e.g., Allrecipes, BBC Good Food).
 - Video platforms (e.g., YouTube, Instagram, TikTok).
 - **Television:** Cooking shows and competitions (e.g., *Maggi Kitchen*, *Knorr Taste Quest*).
 - **Food Packaging:** Simple recipes are often printed on the back of product labels (e.g., on a pack of spaghetti or a tin of evaporated milk).
 - **Chefs and Culinary Schools:** Formal training.

4.3 METHODS OF COLLECTING INFORMATION FOR RECIPES

1. **Observation and Interviewing:** This is the method for primary sources. You must carefully watch a skilled person (like your grandmother) as they cook. Since they often don't use measurements ("a pinch of this," "a little of that"), you must ask questions and try to *measure* what they use (e.g., "Let me see that 'pinch' in a teaspoon").
2. **Reading and Research:** This involves collecting and comparing written recipes from cookbooks or websites.
3. **Practical Experimentation:** This involves taking a base recipe and *adapting* it. This is "experimental cookery." You change one variable at a time (e.g., "What happens if I add ginger?" "What if I use butter instead of margarine?") and record the results.

4.4 ANALYSE THE IMPORTANCE OF COLLECTING RECIPE INFORMATION

1. **Preservation of Culture:** It is the primary way that traditional dishes and family heritage are saved from being forgotten.
2. **Standardization:** A good recipe ensures that a dish will be the same *every time*. This is essential for restaurants and food businesses.
3. **Basis for Experimentation:** You must first understand the *standard* recipe for Jollof rice before you can start to experiment and create your own "special" version.
4. **Costing and Menu Planning:** You cannot price a dish on a menu if you don't know the exact ingredients and quantities required to make it.
5. **Nutritional Analysis:** A recipe with exact quantities allows a nutritionist to calculate the food's nutritional value (calories, protein, vitamins).

4.5 ADVANTAGES OF RECIPES

1. **Consistency (Quality Control):** Guarantees the same taste, texture, and appearance every time.
2. **Cost Control:** By specifying exact amounts, it prevents the waste of expensive ingredients.
3. **Time Management:** A recipe allows you to plan your cooking, shop efficiently, and know how long the dish will take.

4. **Delegation:** A good recipe allows someone else (e.g., a junior staff member) to prepare the dish correctly without your supervision.
5. **Success for Beginners:** It gives new cooks the confidence and guidance to produce a successful dish.
6. **Safety:** A recipe includes important safety and hygiene steps (e.g., "cook chicken until no longer pink").

4.6 CREATE A RECIPE (EXAMPLE FORMAT)

Title: Simple 4-Portion Jollof Rice **Yield:** Serves 4 people **Prep Time:** 15 minutes **Cook Time:** 40 minutes

Ingredients:

- 3 cups parboiled rice
- 1/2 cup vegetable oil
- 4 fresh plum tomatoes (or 1 tin of tomato paste)
- 2 large red bell peppers (Tatashe)
- 1-2 Scotch bonnet peppers (Ata Rodo)
- 1 large onion
- 1 tbsp curry powder
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 2 stock cubes (e.g., Maggi or Knorr)
- Salt to taste
- 3 cups chicken or beef stock (or water)

Method (Step-by-Step):

1. **Prepare the Pepper Base:** Blend the tomatoes, red bell peppers, scotch bonnets, and half of the onion until smooth.
2. **Fry the Base:** Heat the oil in a large pot. Finely chop the remaining half of the onion and fry until soft (about 3-5 minutes).

3. Pour in the blended pepper base. Fry on medium heat for 10-15 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the stew has thickened and the oil begins to separate.
4. **Season:** Add the curry powder, thyme, stock cubes, and salt. Stir well and cook for another 2 minutes.
5. **Add Rice:** Wash the parboiled rice thoroughly and add it to the pot. Stir well to coat every grain in the stew mixture.
6. **Add Stock:** Pour in the 3 cups of stock (or water). The liquid should be at the same level as the rice.
7. **Cook:** Bring to a boil, then immediately reduce the heat to the lowest possible setting. Cover the pot *tightly* (use foil if needed) and let it simmer for 25-30 minutes.
8. **Finish:** Do not stir the rice while it is simmering. After 30 minutes, check it. If the liquid is gone and the rice is soft, it is ready. If not, add a tiny bit more water and cover for 5-10 more minutes.
9. **Serve:** Fluff the rice with a fork and serve hot with chicken or fish.

EVALUATION

1. What are the three essential components of any recipe?
2. List two primary sources and two secondary sources of recipes.
3. Give three advantages of using a standardized recipe in a restaurant.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Using the format shown in section 4.6, write a complete recipe for a simple dish you know how to cook (e.g., Scrambled Eggs, Boiled Yam and Egg Sauce, or Indomie).

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

This week is for the Midterm Examination, which will cover all topics from Weeks 1-4.



WEEK 6: TEST INTERPRETATION

6.1 INTERPRET GIVEN COOKERY TEST QUESTIONS

The WAEC/NECO practical examination questions (and mock exams) are not simple instructions like "Cook rice." They are **scenarios** (or "tests") that you must interpret. You are marked on *how well* you meet all the requirements of the scenario.

How to Break Down a Question: When you see a question, identify the **keywords**:

1. **The Task:** "Prepare, cook, and serve..."
2. **The Meal:** "...a two-course meal..." "...a one-course meal..." "...a snack..."
3. **The Recipient:** "...for a manual labourer..." "...for a diabetic patient..." "...for a toddler..."
"...for a lacto-ovo vegetarian..."
4. **The Constraint:** "...using locally available ingredients..." "...that is packed in a suitable container..." "...that is rich in Vitamin C..."

Example 1:

"Prepare, cook, and serve a **three-course meal** suitable for a **convalescent** (a person recovering from illness). The meal should be **light and nourishing**."

- **Interpretation:**
 - **Task:** Three courses (e.g., Starter, Main, Dessert).
 - **Recipient:** Convalescent. This is the key. They need food that is:
 - **Light:** Easily digestible (not oily, not spicy, not heavy).
 - **Nourishing:** Nutrient-dense, high in protein (for repair) and vitamins (for immunity).
 - **My Dish Choice (Example):**
 - Starter: Light Chicken Broth (Nourishing, hydrating)
 - Main: Steamed Fish with Boiled Potatoes and Carrots (Protein, easy to digest)
 - Dessert: Egg Flip or a Fruit Puree (Nourishing, easy to eat)

- **Bad Choice:** Eba and Egusi Soup (too heavy), Jollof Rice (can be oily/spicy).

Example 2:

"Using locally available ingredients, prepare, cook, and serve a **nutritious one-course meal** for a **lacto-ovo vegetarian**."

- **Interpretation:**

- **Task:** One-course meal (a single, balanced dish).
- **Recipient:** Lacto-ovo vegetarian. This means **NO MEAT, NO FISH**. But **EGGS** and **DAIRY (milk/cheese)** are allowed.
- **Constraint:** "Locally available." Use Nigerian staples.
- **My Dish Choice (Example):**
 - Boiled Yam with a well-prepared Egg Sauce/Stew (with plenty of tomatoes and onions).
 - Beans Porridge with Boiled Plantain (if eggs/dairy are not used, beans provide protein).
- **Bad Choice:** Jollof Rice with Chicken (contains meat), Rice and Fish Stew (contains fish).

6.2 WRITE OUT RESPONSES TO COOKING TEST QUESTIONS

The "response" is the written work you must do *before* you start cooking. This is your **PLAN**. It is usually marked out of 30-40% of the total.

Your written response must include:

1. **Choice of Dish:** State clearly what you have chosen to cook, based on your interpretation.
 - *e.g., "For my test, I will prepare a two-course meal for a diabetic: Grilled Fish with a side of Steamed Vegetables (Main) and a Fresh Fruit Salad (Dessert)."*
2. **List of Ingredients:** A "shopping list" with quantities.
 - *e.g., Fish (1 mackerel), Ugwu (1 small bunch), Carrots (2), etc.*
3. **List of Equipment:** The key items you will need.

- *e.g., Frying pan, pot, knives, chopping board, grater, serving plates.*
- 4. **Time Plan / Schedule of Work:** This is the most important part. It is a step-by-step plan showing what you will do and when. (See Week 8 for a detailed example).
- 5. **Order of Work:** A summary of your plan (e.g., "First, I will wash and prep all vegetables. Second, I will boil the yam. Third, I will make the egg sauce...").

EVALUATION

1. Interpret the following test: "Prepare, cook, and serve a one-course meal for an **overweight** person." What is the main nutritional goal for this meal?
2. Interpret the following test: "Prepare, cook, and serve a **high-protein** snack for a **vegan**." What ingredients can you *not* use? What could you use for protein?
3. What are the 4 main parts of a written "response" to a practical test?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Scenario:** "You are asked to prepare a two-course meal for a 4-year-old child's lunch." (a) Interpret the scenario (what does a 4-year-old need?). (b) Write down your "Choice of Dish" (Main + Dessert) that would be suitable.

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

This week is for the midterm break.



WEEK 8: COOKING ASSIGNMENT

8.1 INTERPRET GIVEN COOKERY TEST QUESTIONS

- This week, we will practice interpreting more complex questions and focus entirely on creating the Time Plan.
- **Scenario (Test Question):**

"You have 90 minutes. Prepare, cook, and serve a **two-course lunch** suitable for a **manual labourer** (e.g., a bricklayer). The meal should be **energy-giving** and packed in **suitable containers** to be eaten at a work site."

- **Interpretation:**
 - **Time:** 90 minutes (1.5 hours).
 - **Task:** Two-course lunch.
 - **Recipient:** Manual Labourer.
 - **Nutritional Need:** **High Energy** (Carbohydrates) to fuel work. **High Protein** to repair muscles.
 - **Constraint:** "Packed in suitable containers." This means you must present the food in a **food flask** and **containers**, not on a fancy plate.
- **My Dish Choice:**
 - **Main Course:** Eba (high energy) with Egusi Soup (protein from melon seeds, fat for energy) with Beef (protein).
 - **Second Course:** A simple Fruit Salad (for vitamins) or a nourishing drink like Kunu.
 - **Alternative Main:** "Student-style" Jollof Rice and Beans with Chicken.

8.2 WRITE OUT TIME AND COOKING SCHEDULES FOR THE TESTS

This is the most critical skill for the practical exam. Your plan must be logical, detailed, and fit the time.

EXAMPLE TIME PLAN

- **Test:** 90-minute test for a manual labourer.
- **Choice:** Jollof Rice and Beans with Grilled Chicken, and a Fruit Salad.

Time	Duration	Task (Order of Work)	Details (Why I'm doing it)
9:00 - 9:15	15 mins	Mise en Place (Preparation)	Wash and chop all veg (onions, pepper, tomatoes, fruit). Wash chicken. Wash rice and beans. Get all equipment.
9:15 - 9:35	20 mins	Cook Chicken & Start Rice/Beans	Season and boil chicken to create stock. Start frying pepper base for jollof in another pot.
9:35 - 9:45	10 mins	Combine Rice/Beans	Add washed rice and pre-cooked beans to the fried base. Add the chicken stock. Cover to simmer.
9:45 - 9:55	10 mins	Grill Chicken & Prep Fruit	Remove boiled chicken from stock, brush with oil, and place under the grill/in hot pan. While it grills, chop fruits (banana, pineapple) for salad.
9:55 - 10:05	10 mins	Wash Up (Part 1)	Clear and wash all prep bowls and chopping boards. Tidy the workstation. Check the rice.
10:05 - 10:15	10 mins	Dish Up & Presentation	Check rice and chicken. Pack the hot Jollof Rice & Chicken into a food flask. Pack the fruit salad into a sealed plastic container.
10:15 - 10:25	10 mins	Serve & Final Wash Up	Arrange the packed items neatly on a tray (as you would "serve" it). Complete all washing up. Clean and wipe all surfaces.
10:25 - 10:30	5 mins	Final Check	Final check of workstation. Present the tray to the examiner.

EVALUATION

1. What is the nutritional keyword to focus on for a "manual labourer"?
2. What does the constraint "packed in suitable containers" mean for your final presentation?
3. Why is "Mise en Place" the first step in a time plan?
4. Why is "Wash Up" included *during* the cooking time and not just at the end?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Scenario:** "You have 1 hour. Prepare, cook, and serve a **nutritious one-course breakfast** for a **school-age child** before they go to school." (a) Write down your **Choice of Dish**. (b) Create a **Time Plan** for the 1 hour, breaking it down into 10-minute blocks.



WEEK 9: PRACTICAL COOKERY EXERCISES

9.1 CARRY OUT SELECTED COOKING ASSIGNMENTS

This week is about putting the plans from Weeks 6-8 into practice. The focus is on **process and skills**.

Key Focus Areas:

1. Mise en Place (Getting Ready):

- Before any heat is turned on, the student must be fully prepared.
- This involves:
 - Collecting all ingredients from the store.
 - Collecting all necessary equipment (pots, pans, knives, bowls, etc.).
 - Washing, peeling, and chopping all vegetables.
 - Measuring out dry ingredients (e.g., flour, rice).
 - Washing and preparing proteins (e.g., fish, meat).
- *A good 'Mise en Place' saves time and reduces stress.*

2. Hygiene in Practice:

- **Personal:** Clean apron, hair covered, short fingernails, no jewellery.
- **Hand Washing:** Must be done at the start, after touching raw meat/fish, after coughing, and after touching a bin.
- **Kitchen:** Clean-as-you-go. Wiping spills *immediately*.
- **Cross-Contamination:** Using separate chopping boards for raw meat and vegetables. Washing any knife that has touched raw meat.

3. Application of Cooking Principles:

- Using the correct cooking method (e.g., boiling, frying, grilling).
- Not overcooking vegetables (to retain water-soluble vitamins like C and B).
- Ensuring protein (meat, fish, eggs) is cooked through to a safe temperature.
- Using heat control (e.g., turning Jollof rice down to *simmer* so it doesn't burn).

9.2 APPLY RECIPE KNOWLEDGE TO PRACTICAL COOKERY TASKS

This involves adapting to real-world situations.

1. Recipe Scaling:

- The recipe might be for 4 people, but the test asks for 1 person.
- The student must demonstrate the ability to *scale* the recipe down (e.g., divide all ingredients by 4).

2. Recipe Adaptation (Substitution):

- The test is for a diabetic, but your recipe includes sugar.
- **Adaptation:** You must substitute the sugar with a diabetic-friendly sweetener or omit it.
- The test is for an ulcer patient, but your recipe includes pepper.
- **Adaptation:** You must *omit* the pepper entirely.

3. Correcting Mistakes:

- What do you do if the soup is too salty? (Add a potato to absorb salt).
- What do you do if the stew is too watery? (Simmer with the lid off to reduce).
- This shows an advanced understanding beyond just following instructions.

EVALUATION

1. What does the French term "Mise en Place" mean?
2. List three important personal hygiene rules to observe during a practical.
3. How would you adapt a recipe for "Beans Porridge" if you were making it for an ulcer patient?
4. Why is it important not to overcook green vegetables?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Your recipe for a cake requires 200g of flour, 150g of sugar, and 4 eggs. This serves 8 people. (a) Scale the recipe down to serve only 2 people. List the new ingredient quantities.

WEEK 10: PRACTICAL ASSESSMENT

10.1 DEMONSTRATE PRACTICAL SKILLS IN FOOD PREPARATION

This week serves as a "Mock Exam." Students will be given a test question (e.g., from Week 8) and will be assessed on their performance from start to finish. The assessment is based on the following criteria, which are used by SSCE examiners.

Assessment Criteria:

- **A. Planning (e.g., 30 Marks)**
 - **Interpretation of the Test:** Did the student understand the question?
 - **Choice of Dish:** Are the chosen dishes appropriate for the scenario (e.g., diabetic, child)?
 - **Time Plan:** Is the plan logical, sequential, and realistic for the time allowed?
 - **Shopping List:** Are all ingredients listed and correct?
- **B. Skills and Method (e.g., 40 Marks)**
 - **Mise en Place:** Was the student organized?
 - **Preparation Skills:** Correct use of knives (chopping, dicing), whisks, etc.
 - **Cooking Method:** Correct application of heat, timing, and principles. Was food cooked through? Were vegetables overcooked?
 - **Hygiene:** *This is assessed throughout.* (Personal, kitchen, cross-contamination).
 - **Economy:** Use of resources, (e.g., not wasting gas, water, or food).
- **C. Presentation and Service (e.g., 30 Marks)**
 - **Quality of Dish:** (Taste, texture, smell, temperature). Is it delicious?
 - **Presentation:** Is the food plated attractively? Is the portion size correct?
 - **Service:** Is the table set correctly for the meal? (See 10.3).

10.2 PRESENT FINISHED FOOD ITEMS

Presentation is the art of making the food look as good as it tastes.

- **Plating:**

- The plate should be clean (wipe any drips from the rim).
- Don't overcrowd the plate.
- Create height (e.g., place the fish *on* the vegetables).
- Use colour (e.g., a green soup in a white bowl).
- **Garnishing:**
 - A garnish is an edible item used to decorate the dish. It must be **appropriate**.
 - *Good Garnish:* A sprig of parsley on rice, a slice of lemon on fish, grated carrot on a salad.
 - *Bad Garnish:* A thick slice of raw onion on a cake.

10.3 APPLY TABLE SETTING AND SERVICE TECHNIQUES IN PRACTICE

The final step is to "serve" the meal. This means presenting it on a correctly set table.

- **Informal Setting (for most tests):**
 - A clean placemat.
 - **Fork** to the left of the plate.
 - **Knife** (blade facing plate) and **Spoon** (if needed) to the right.
 - **Dessert** cutlery (if needed) at the top.
 - **Glass** for water at the top right.
 - A clean, folded **napkin** on the side plate or on the main plate.
- The student must present their finished dish on this set table (or on a tray if the test requires it) for the examiner to assess.

EVALUATION

1. List the three main categories (A, B, C) on which a practical cooking test is assessed.
2. What is a "garnish"? Give one example.
3. Draw a simple diagram of an informal table setting, labeling the fork, knife, and water glass.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Review all your notes from Weeks 1-10.
2. Choose one of the "Test Scenarios" from Week 6 or 8.
3. Write a full, detailed **Time Plan** for it, ready for a 90-minute practical.



WEEK 11: REVISION

- This week is for a general review of all topics covered in the Second Term.
- **Key Theory Topics:**
 - Formal vs. Informal Food Service (Types: Buffet, Cafeteria, etc.).
 - Entrepreneurship (Definitions, pros/cons, success factors).
 - Work Ethics (Punctuality, Hygiene, Honesty).
 - Food Packaging (Reasons, materials, qualities).
- **Key Practical Theory Topics:**
 - Recipe (Definition, sources, advantages).
 - Test Interpretation (How to break down a scenario).
 - Time Planning (Creating a logical schedule of work).
 - Assessment Criteria (Mise en Place, Hygiene, Presentation, Quality).
- Students will practice writing time plans for various SSCE-style questions.

